

and seemed to be awaiting signals from his hip-pocket beeper. We passed various "posts" where stocks were traded and the resulting prices were shown on TV screens overhead. There were numerous kibitzers in solid-colored jackets. Mr. Gollner told me which of these people worked for brokerage firms, which were messengers, which were trading for their own accounts, which were observers, and which were security police for the exchange.

Every now and again we'd pass a phone attached to a metal pole just like you'd find on any street corner. Mr. Gollner would answer it, and it would be for him. How he knew it was for him, and how the other party knew of his exact location on this huge floor I could never figure out. Anyway he'd talk for a minute, hang up the phone, walk toward one of the trading posts, make some odd flapping motions with his hands, turn back toward me and announce:

"It was just filled."

"What was just filled?"

"My order."

"What order?"

"Holiday Inn, 57³/₄."

"I didn't see it."

"Next time maybe you'll see it. Just watch and listen."

Mr. Gollner wrote the results of his supposed trade on a little card that he gave to a guy in a gray jacket. There in front of us was the specialist in Holiday Inn. I'd say he was in his mid-forties: tan pants, madras shirt, Reebok jogging shoes. He had the Book in his hand. I'd love to have peeked into it, but I couldn't get close enough. Between me and the specialist was a crowd of buyers and sellers, haggling over shares. I tried to jump up and down and wave to get his attention, but he seemed to be staring out in space, oblivious to my signals.

"See that?" said Mr. Gollner.

"See what?"

"That man there. Just made an offer to buy. The order came from one of the outer desks, probably from a brokerage firm. Ten thousand shares at 57⁷/₈ he stepped up with. There, it was just accepted. See? Now it's being recorded." He pointed to another man in a gray jacket who was punching the results of the trade